

Cross-Browser & Mobile Testing Guide

Run your tests across browsers and device viewports with confidence.

Introduction

Real users are on different browsers and devices. Playwright makes cross-browser and mobile-viewport testing straightforward through projects. This guide shows you how to use it sensibly.

Projects for Browsers

- Define projects for chromium, firefox and webkit in the config.
- The same tests run across all configured projects.
- Run one with: `npx playwright test --project=firefox`

Mobile Viewports

Use device descriptors (e.g. `devices['iPhone 13']`) in a project to emulate viewport, user agent and touch — useful for catching responsive layout issues.

Worked Example (config projects)

- `{ name: 'chromium', use: devices['Desktop Chrome'] }`
- `{ name: 'webkit', use: devices['Desktop Safari'] }`
- `{ name: 'mobile', use: devices['iPhone 13'] }`

Choosing Scope

Run	When
One browser	Fast local development
All browsers	CI / before release
Mobile viewport	Responsive/critical journeys

Practical Exercise

Add a mobile project to your config and run a key journey on it. Note any layout differences from desktop.

Best Practices

- Develop on one browser; verify on all in CI.
- Focus mobile runs on critical journeys.
- Use device descriptors rather than hand-setting viewports.

Common Mistakes

- Running the full matrix locally and slowing yourself down.
- Emulation differences mistaken for real device bugs.
- Ignoring mobile entirely.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Emulation is great for layout and logic, but it is not a real device. For business-critical mobile flows, confirm key findings on a real device before sign-off.